centre for pediatric emergencies and specialized care

Ingrown toenail

What is an onychectomy with van den Bos procedure?

An onychectomy is a surgery to remove part or all your toenail, indicated when conservative measures failed to resolve a severely inflamed toe from a persistently ingrown toenail. We usually add the Van den Bos procedure to remove part of the skin around it as well to prevent recurrence.

What should I expect following the procedure?

- Pain may be experienced for the first week and can be relieved with Ibuprofen or Acetaminophen (follow the instructions on the bottle).
- **IN THE FIRST 24 HOURS**, do not remove the pressure bandage and keep your foot elevated as much as possible to help minimize post-operative pain and bleeding. If blood soaking through, simply apply additional gauze on top of the pressure dressing. **DO NOT take off the original bandage for 24 hours**.
- **CAN return to school** the next day, but no gym for 1 week.

What should you do in the days following the procedure?

- **REMOVE BANDAGE:** On the 2nd day post-surgery, soak your pressure bandage in warm water and then remove slowly.
- **START SOAKING AREA 3 times a day**.
  - Soak the area in warm water (bathtub or Sitz bath) for 15 minutes each time
  - Keep your toe clean and dry between soaks
- **BANDAGE** A light bandage (ex. gauze or Band-Aid) can be applied as needed.
  - May experience small amounts of oozing, bleeding, or redness for up to 4 weeks, at which time full healing is expected to have completed.
- **AVOID TIGHT SHOES** that press on your toe.
- **AVOID SPORTS** for 1 weeks following the procedure.

What complications should I monitor for?

- There is redness spreading from the cut to nearby skin
- Wound is hurting more than before
- There is pus (yellow/green liquid, sometimes with a bad smell) coming from the wound
- Any of the above with fever (> 38 degrees Celcius)
- Bleeding that you cannot stop with pressure dressing

What do I do if have a wound complication?

Return to Centre UP at the site closest to your home between 8am-8pm; no appointment needed.

If notice something at night, unless major bleeding or severe pain, can come first thing in the AM.

*The recommendations provided in this document are based on general knowledge and experience in the field. However, the educational material contained in this document is NOT a substitute for the clinical judgment necessary to address the diverse needs of patients.